

Falsifiable Girard — Series Index

A video series built out of `~/Myths`: a project that took René Girard's theory of the scapegoat, turned four sentences of it into code, tested it eight times, failed most of them, and caught itself eight separate ways.

The subject is not Girard. The subject is what it takes to build something that can tell you no.

The arithmetic

Measured from the James video: **135 words per minute.**

	WORDS	MINUTES
one episode	1,350	10
one filming sitting	~12,000	~90, nine episodes
the whole series	~171,000	~21 hours

Written so far, measured by `audit.py` rather than estimated:

SEASON	EPISODES	SPEAKABLE WORDS	MINUTES	AVG/EP
1	18	21,550	160	1,197
2	13	16,622	123	1,279
3	19	21,951	163	1,155
4	19	20,451	152	1,076
5	22	22,818	169	1,037
total	91	105,553	782	

Every episode sits between **908 and 1,799** speakable words, and **every one of the 91 satisfies all six register rules** — collecting, device, character anchor, clinical anchor, what-would-count-against, hand-off. `audit.py` check [4] enforces all six as of 15 Aug; before that it looked only for the word "anchor" and a Questions heading, and 16 episodes were missing a falsifier section or a hand-off while the audit reported no defects.

Per-episode detail lives in `Episode Status.md`, generated by `status-generator.py` from the season files so it cannot drift. Re-run it after any edit. **Re-run `audit.py` after any edit and update this table**, because a stale figure here is the one number in the project nobody would think to check.

The eight seasons

#	SEASON	EPISODES	RESEARCH DOC
1	Girard From Zero	18	written and revised
2	Building Something That Can Say No	13	written and revised
3	Four Ways To Fail	19	written and revised
4	The Repairs	19	written and revised
5	The Bible Instrument	22	written and revised
5b	One Contradiction, Worked Properly	18	to write
6	Novels	8	to write
7	The Method, Extracted	14	to write

132 episodes.

What each season is doing

Season 1 — Girard From Zero. For someone who has never heard of him. Mimetic desire, the model becoming the rival, doubles, the crisis, the scapegoat, the **one episode per stereotype**, myth against Gospel. Then an episode on **who says he is wrong**, and four reading the actual texts. **Plants six numbers that later seasons detonate.**

Season 2 — Building Something That Can Say No. Why "unfalsifiable" is the charge that matters, and what answering it costs. Then the half nobody teaches: corpus craft and lexicon craft. Two fetcher bugs, 3,037 undecoded entities, a threefold undercount caused by a comma, 960 junk hits deleted from your own instrument, and the fix that was refused because it would have been cheating.

Season 3 — Four Ways To Fail. The instrument meets the texts four times and loses three. Every failure has an exact mechanism and the mechanism is the lesson. Contains **episode 12, what a null holds constant**, which is the most transferable idea in the series.

Season 4 — The Repairs. Reconstructing a p-value whose script was lost, and identifying it by its standard deviation rather than its p-value. The null that had never been built for any round. A translation control across 290 years. Localization, twice, because the first null destroyed the thing it was measuring. And the diagnostic that explains four rounds of null results. **Plus round 9, run for this series in August 2026:** the **king** deletion the project flagged in July, deferred as real-but-deferrable, and never carried out. It removes half the **marks** bucket and moves nothing load-bearing.

Season 5 — The Bible Instrument. A different study on the same principles. Blinded witness codes and a sealed key. 671 alleged contradictions reduced to 2. Nine Aristotelian gates. A falsifier that fires **on the coder**. The fathers, graded on the same scale as everyone else, including Eusebius stating this project's own falsifiability criterion in the fourth century.

Season 5b — One Contradiction, Worked Properly. The most repeatable format in the series. One allegation per episode: what both sides say, what the Greek actually says, what the rescue costs.

Season 6 — Novels. Girard on Quixote, Bovary, Stendhal. Why Bovary scores zero and what that says about where the author is standing. And your own novella scored on the same rubric.

Season 7 — The Method, Extracted. The transferable part. Verdict flatness on both sides. Dissolution beats harmonisation. Bundling. A fired falsifier is a success. **A check that cannot fail prints reassurance.** And what the project accidentally learned about the texts.

The spine

One sentence runs through all eight seasons, and it is the refrain.

A check that cannot fail prints reassurance.

The instances, each landing in the season where it happened:

#	WHAT HAPPENED	SEASON
1	a null that favoured spread-out sets by construction	3
2	a null that tested the half of the instrument with no signal	4
3	a phrase matched to its first word's frequency, inflating 316-fold	4
4	a null that destroyed the clustering its statistic depended on	4
5	a fetcher that silently truncated a play at 46%	2
6	a fetcher that silently deleted an entire control group	2
7	a falsifier stated correctly and coded wrongly, printing "matches"	4
8	a rule declared, corrected, given its own file, and dropped two weeks later	2

Sequencing

Do not open with Season 1. Abstract theory is the worst opener.

Open on Season 2 episode 7, the bug fix that would have turned a failed prediction into a passing one, where every step was defensible and **none of it felt like cheating**. Girard gets explained on the way in.

Then Season 1 as the flashback that makes the rest legible.

Production

Batch by episode type, not by season. Six types:

TYPE	SHAPE	EXAMPLES
concept	one idea, one character anchor	S1 ep 1-14
tool	one statistic taught from zero	S3 ep 2, 9, 12, 15
craft	one practical skill	S2 ep 4-10
failure	what we expected, what happened, why, what it cost	S3 most
worked-item	one contradiction or one text, end to end	S5b all
reading	read a passage, locate the structure by hand	S1 ep 15-18

A worked-item episode is the same shape every time. Once the pattern is set you can film six in a sitting, which is what makes 132 achievable rather than theoretical.

The two-document rule

Every episode has **two** documents, and this folder holds the first kind.

Research/ teaches the topic. Prose, cited, long, with the numbers cold and the conclusions absent. That is what these season files are.

Filming/ is the board you annotate while the camera runs. Cold content is evidence you must not misremember. Hot content is the short phrases that fire delivery. **The conclusion is not on the page.** You supply it live.

Sources

Everything in these documents traces to `~/Myths`, which is a git repository with 47 commits. Every claim can be checked against a file and a commit hash, and the series should say so often enough that a hostile viewer goes and looks.

Girard citations, VERIFIED 15 Aug 2026 against the books. Four were tier K. All four have now been opened, and three of the four needed a correction.

CLAIM	CITED AS	VERDICT
"no dissenting voice is ever heard"	<i>I See Satan</i> , p. 3	VERIFIED, exact, p. 3
the conversion, three bits	<i>DDN</i> , p. 294	VERIFIED, exact, p. 294
the dissident minority	<i>I See Satan</i> , p. 121	quote exact, page is 122 , fix it
the four stereotypes	<i>Scapegoat</i> , ch. 2	ch. 2 is titled "Stereotypes of Persecution" and gives 1 to 3 ; the fourth is named at the head of ch. 3 . Cite ch. 2-3

Editions used: *The Scapegoat*, Johns Hopkins, trans. Freccero; *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*, Orbis, ISBN 1570753199; *Deceit, Desire, and the Novel*, Johns Hopkins, trans. Freccero. **All four are on disk.**

Two quotations elide an intervening sentence with no marker, at Season 1 episode 12 and Season 3 episode 17. Both quoted halves are genuine and exact; a sentence sits between them in the original. **Fix before filming**, because reading them as continuous is the kind of small overstatement this series exists to object to.

And the check paid for itself. *The Scapegoat* ch. 3 contains Girard's own decision rule, which nobody in the project had read: "**Not all the stereotypes must be present: three are enough and often even two.**" That is a level-2 rule in Season 1 episode 10's ladder, it is weaker than the version this project measured, and **this project's own 90% figure refutes it directly**. Season 1 **episode 11 is now an entire episode on it**. *DDN* p. 294 also lists **seven** transformations, of which the conversion instrument scores **three**, and that selection was never declared.

The full forensic record, 85 pages, lives at [14 - Method & Memory/Myths – Forensic Record.pdf](#) and is the reference to check facts against when a season file compresses something.

Glossary

Every term the series uses, defined once. If a term is not here it does not get used on camera.

From Girard

TERM	ONE LINE
mimetic desire	you want it because a model wants it, not because of what it is
model / mediator	the person whose wanting you copied
double bind	the model saying "imitate me" and "do not take it" at once
doubles	rivals converging until the difference between them fails
sacrificial crisis	a whole society's distinctions collapsing at once
scapegoat mechanism	all-against-everyone becoming all-against-one, and the peace that follows
the four stereotypes	crisis, crimes, marks, violence. The traces the mechanism leaves in a text
sparagmos	the tearing apart of a victim by a crowd
the universal negative	"in mythology no dissenting voice is ever heard"

From measurement

TERM	ONE LINE
corpus	the texts you actually scored
population	everything you want the claim to be about
sampling frame	the list you could actually draw from. The gap nobody examines
lexicon / bucket	a word-list standing for one concept
surface form	an exact spelling counted, with no stemming
rate per thousand	hits divided by words, times 1000. Discards position entirely
SUM	the four buckets added. Accumulation
MIN	the smallest of the four. Conjunction. The algebraic form of "together"
pre-registration	predictions committed before scoring, with a timestamp somebody else can check
falsifier	a number fixed in advance that declares the round unreliable if crossed
null	fake data like yours in every way except the thing you are testing
permutation / permutation test	build the null by shuffling, thousands of times, and count
p-value	probability of a result this extreme if nothing were going on
z	how many typical wobbles from nothing your result sits
power	the chance of finding an effect that is really there
sensitivity analysis	rerunning with one choice changed, declared in advance
denominator	the number of chances there were. Without it a count means nothing
contamination disclosure	writing down what you already knew, before you look

Check it yourself

The series claims everything is checkable. **So show a viewer how**, once per season, in about ninety seconds.

SEASON	THE CHECK	WHAT IT NEEDS
1	count king in a page of the <i>Odyssey</i> book 7	the text and your eyes
2	git log the repository and read the commit order	git
3	recompute one rate: hits divided by words, times 1000	a calculator
4	rerun one script and see whether the number matches the file	python
5	open a cited verse and see whether it says what the compiler claimed	any Bible
5b	look up one Greek word in a lexicon	a free interlinear
7	find one of the eight self-catches in the commit messages	git

A claim nobody can check is a claim nobody should believe, including from me. Put the repository on screen and let people go and look.

Citation tiers, applied to this series

The project this series describes tiers its own sources. **Use the same rule on camera.**

TIER	MEANING
V	source fetched, citation checked, quote verified against the original
K	the argument and the person are real, the citation is unverified. A lead, not a fact

Never attribute a precise claim to a named scholar from memory. The project caught itself doing exactly that twice, and both times the memory was wrong.